doesn't require previous moments—previous frames—to be "sequentially illuminated."[6]

And if you think about it for one more moment, you'll realize that's a very good thing, because the notion of a projector light sequentially bringing moments to life is highly problematic for another, even more basic reason. If the projector light properly did its job and illuminated a given moment—say, the stroke of midnight, New Year's Eve, 1999—what would it mean for that moment to then go dark? If the moment were lit, then being illuminated would be a feature of the moment, a feature as everlasting and unchanging as everything else happening at that moment. To experience illumination—to be "alive," to be the present, to be *the now*—and to then experience darkness—to be "dormant," to be the past, to be what was—is to experience change. *But the concept of change has no meaning with respect to a single moment in time.* The change would have to occur through time, the change would mark the passing of time, but what notion of time could that possibly be? By definition, moments *don't* include the passing of time—at least, not the time we're aware of— because moments just are, they are the raw material of time, they *don't* change. A particular moment can no more change in time than a particular location can move in space: if the location were to move, it would be a different location in space; if a moment in time were to change, it would be a different moment in time. The intuitive image of a projector light that brings each new *now* to life just doesn't hold up to careful examination. Instead, every moment is illuminated, and every moment remains illuminated. Every moment *is.* Under close scrutiny, the flowing river of time more closely resembles a giant block of ice with every moment forever frozen into place.[7]

This conception of time is significantly different from the one most of us have internalized. Even though it emerged from his own insights, Einstein was not hardened to the difficulty of fully absorbing such a profound change in perspective. Rudolf Carnap[8] recounts a wonderful conversation he had with Einstein on this subject: "Einstein said that the problem of the now worried him seriously. He explained that the experience of the now means something special for man, something essentially different from the past and the future, but that this important difference does not and cannot occur within physics. That this